

Standard Operating Guidelines: Food Delivery Operations

Quality Assurance, Temperature Control, and Logistics Protocols

1. Objective & Scope

These guidelines outline the standard operating procedures required to maintain safety, food quality, and customer satisfaction during courier-based delivery operations. This policy applies to all internal dispatch personnel, third-party logistics partners, and fulfillment center staff.

2. Food Safety & Temperature Governance

Maintaining proper thermal control during transit is paramount to preventing microbial growth and ensuring sensory quality. All meals must be packed and transported according to the following strict thresholds:

Critical Control Limits (HACCP):

- **Hot Foods:** Must be maintained at or above 60°C (140°F) throughout the entire transit window.
- **Cold Foods:** Must be maintained at or below 4°C (40°F) to prevent pathogen proliferation.
- **Maximum Transit Time:** No food item shall remain in transit for more than 45 minutes from the point of packaging to final handover.

2.1 Thermal Equipment Specifications

- **Insulated Delivery Bags:** All couriers must utilize high-grade, multi-layered insulated delivery backpacks featuring commercial-grade thermal lining.
- **Physical Segregation:** Hot and cold items must never occupy the same thermal compartment. Separate insulated compartments or distinct thermal bags must be utilized for beverage/refrigerated items and hot entrees.
- **Sanitization Schedule:** Thermal bags must be sanitized internally and externally at the start and end of each shift using a certified food-safe quaternary ammonium sanitizer.

3. Packaging & Sealing Protocols

To preserve structural integrity and guarantee consumer confidence, all fulfillment hubs must strictly enforce the following presentation and security rules:

Food Category	Primary Packaging Requirement	Tamper-Evident Mechanism
Liquids / Soups / Gravies	Double-rimmed, leak-proof polypropylene containers with interior silicone gaskets.	Heat-shrink plastic band wrap around the lid perimeter.
Hot Fried / Crispy Items	Ventilated, moisture-wicking paperboard cartons to prevent steam condensation.	High-tack branded paper seal covering the structural closure tabs.
Chilled Entrées / Salads	PET clear-view containers with tight-fitting recessed lids.	Perforated security sticker crossing from lid to base container body.

4. Courier Conduct & Handover Procedures

Couriers represent the final touchpoint of the consumer experience and must maintain rigorous personal and professional standards.

4.1 Hygiene and Attire

Couriers must wear clean, company-branded apparel, keep hair neatly tied back, and maintain impeccable hand hygiene. Hands must be sanitized immediately prior to removing food containers from the thermal delivery bags.

4.2 Contactless Handover Protocol

1. Upon arrival at the destination, place the delivery platform/surface down if requested, or present the bag to allow the customer to pull the order safely.
2. For contactless drop-offs, place the order on a clean, elevated surface specified by the client, step back a minimum of two meters, and capture a digital proof-of-delivery photograph via the application.
3. Verbally confirm the order number or name from a safe distance before final departure.